Reiko Laski

Contact Information

(781) 835-9115
rlaski@stanford.edu
reiko.laski@gmail.com
www.reikolaski.com

Education

Stanford University, Ph.D. in Economics 2021 – Expected 2027
Fields: Macroeconomics, Economic Growth, Innovation, Firm Dynamics

Emory University, Bachelor of Arts in Economics and Mathematics 2015 – 2019
Minor in Computer Informatics
Thesis: "Access to Pharmaceuticals in Developing Countries" (advisor: Stephen O'Connell)

Working Papers

Sectoral Innovation Complementarities
Job Market Paper

Technological advances in one industry can strengthen incentives for firms in other industries to innovate. I study whether downstream innovation increases demand for upstream inputs and makes developing better inputs more profitable. Using Compustat supply-chain links and financial market reactions to patent grants, I measure changes in suppliers' market value associated with customer innovation. Each additional 1% of a customer's market value created by its own innovation is associated with an additional 0.33% increase in its supplier's market value. Suppliers who experience larger increases in market value due to customer innovation see subsequent increases in sales and patenting in the following years, consistent with customer innovation increasing demand for inputs and encouraging further innovation by suppliers. I develop and calibrate a multisector endogenous growth model to study how interactions between customer and supplier innovation affect the gap between the private and social returns to research. The empirical relationship between customer and supplier valuation changes following customer innovation helps distinguish models with different implications for how to allocate R&D subsidies. In the calibrated model, targeting R&D subsidies toward suppliers raises annual growth by an additional 8 basis points relative to a uniform subsidy at the same fiscal cost.

Idea Rents and Firm Growth with Timo Boppart, Pete Klenow, and Huiyu Li
NBER Working Paper No. 35594

Which firms drive aggregate productivity growth? We document that firms with high price-earnings ratios tend to see increases in their subsequent earnings relative to sales, which we interpret as rents from ideas (innovation). We construct an endogenous growth model with shocks to firm innovation step sizes and R&D efficiency and calibrate it to match patterns in the data. The model implies that growth would be much lower, even with the same innovative effort, if firms had the same step sizes. The model can be used to infer expected growth contributions of individual firms (such as members of the Magnificent Seven). We find that the share of growth coming from smaller listed firms substantially exceeds their sales share.

Selected Works in Progress

The Market's Expectation of AI-Driven Growth
with Timo Boppart, Pete Klenow, and Huiyu Li

The Growth Implications of Heterogeneous Firm-to-Firm Knowledge Spillovers
with Emmanuella Kyei Manu

Policy Writing	"Why Don't Low-Income Countries Adopt More Productive Technologies?" with Nicholas Trachter. *Richmond Fed Economic Brief* No. 21-11	2021
	"The Effect of Lockdown Measures on Unemployment" with Marios Karabarbounis, James Lee, and Nicholas Trachter. *Richmond Fed Special Report*	2020
Honors and Awards	E.S. Shaw and B.F. Haley Fellowship for Economics, SIEPR	2027
	Centennial Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford School of Humanities and Sciences	2025
	Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford University ×3	2023, 2024, 2025
	Highest Honors in Economics, Emory University	2019
	Open Source Macroeconomics Laboratory Student Research Grant, University of Chicago	2018
Presentations	Innovation Complementarities, *Stanford Macroeconomics Seminar*	2026
	Innovation Complementarities, *Stanford Macro Workshop*	2026
	Idea Rents and Firm Growth, *Stanford Macro Day*	2024
Work Experience	Research Assistant to Pete Klenow	2022 – present
	Research Associate, Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond	2019 – 2021
Teaching Assistantships	Climate Change and Global Inequality, Stanford	2026
	International Finance, Stanford	2025
	International Trade, Stanford	2023 – 2024
	Intermediate Microeconomics, Emory	2019
	Introductory Physics, Emory	2016 – 2018
Skills	Python, Stata, MATLAB, Java, SQL, LaTeX, Julia, R	
Professional Activities and Service	Moderator, Stanford Economics Graduate Career Day Tech Panel	2026
	Co-Chair, Stanford Women in Macro	2025 – 2026
	Recruitment Committee, Department of Economics, Stanford University	2023
	Special Sworn Status Researcher, U.S. Census Bureau	2022 – present
	Growth Reading Group, Stanford University	2022 – present
	Social Chair, Stanford Department of Economics	2021 – 2022
	Refereeing: *Journal of Political Economy: Macroeconomics*	